Lecture 4: Householder reflector, Givens rotation, Least squares problem



School of Mathematical Sciences, Xiamen University

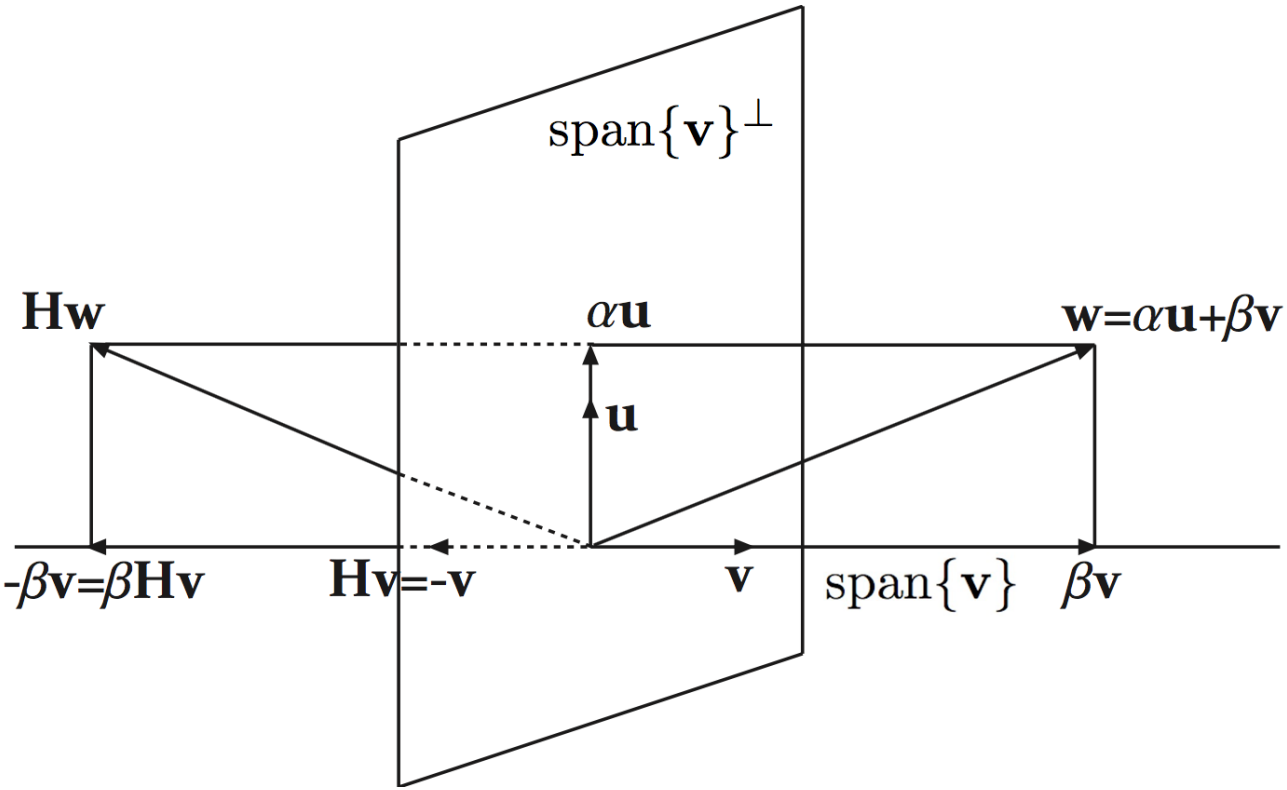
1. Householder reflector

- Let $\mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{C}^m$ and $\mathbf{v} \neq \mathbf{0}$. Then the matrix

$$\mathbf{H} = \mathbf{I} - 2\frac{\mathbf{v}\mathbf{v}^*}{\mathbf{v}^*\mathbf{v}},$$

  is called a *Householder reflector*.

- Geometric interpretation



Exercise: Householder reflector $\mathbf{H}$ satisfies the following properties:

(1) It is *Hermitian*: $\mathbf{H} = \mathbf{H}^*$

(2) It is *unitary*: $\mathbf{H}^* = \mathbf{H}^{-1}$

(3) It is *involutory*: $\mathbf{H}^2 = \mathbf{I}$

Exercise: What are the eigenvalues, the determinant, and the singular values of a Householder reflector $\mathbf{H}$?

Hint: eigenvalues 1 with multiplicity $m-1$ and -1 with multiplicity 1.

Exercise: Assume that $\mathbf{v}^*\mathbf{u} \neq 0$. Prove that $\mathbf{I} - \dfrac{\mathbf{u}\mathbf{v}^*}{\mathbf{v}^*\mathbf{u}}$ is the projector onto the *hyperplane* $\mathrm{span}\{\mathbf{v}\}^\perp$ along $\mathrm{span}\{\mathbf{u}\}$.

- Further reading: M. Shao,

  Householder orthogonalization with a nonstandard inner product, SIAM J. Matrix Anal. Appl. 44 (2023), no.2, 481–502.

Theorem 1

For all $\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{y} \in \mathbb{C}^m$ *with* $\mathbf{x} \neq \mathbf{y}$, *there exists a Householder reflector* $\mathbf{H}$ *such that* $\mathbf{Hx} = \mathbf{y}$ *if and only if* $\|\mathbf{x}\|_2 = \|\mathbf{y}\|_2$ *and* $\mathbf{x}^*\mathbf{y} \in \mathbb{R}$.

Proof.

"$\Rightarrow$" is easy. "$\Leftarrow$": let $\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{x} - \mathbf{y}$, verify $\mathbf{Hx} = \mathbf{y}$. □

Corollary 2

For all nonzero $\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{y} \in \mathbb{C}^m$ *with* $\mathbf{x} \neq \mathbf{y}$, *there exists a Householder reflector* $\mathbf{H}$ *and* $z \in \mathbb{C}$ *such that* $\mathbf{Hx} = z\mathbf{y}$.

Proof.

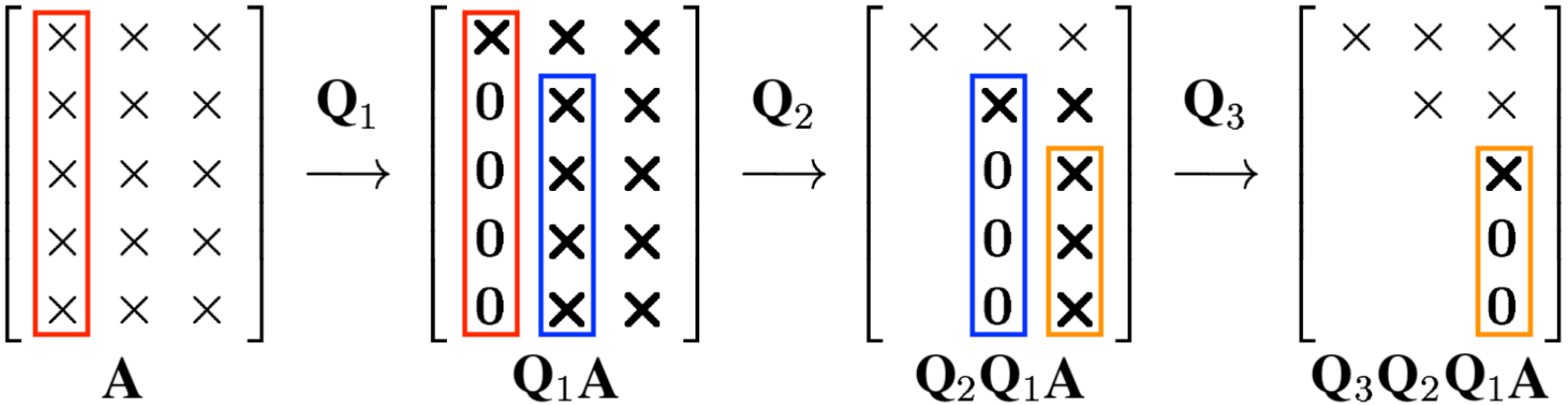
Let

$$z = \frac{\|\mathbf{x}\|_2}{\|\mathbf{y}\|_2} \cdot c, \qquad c = \begin{cases} \pm \mathbf{y}^*\mathbf{x}/|\mathbf{x}^*\mathbf{y}|, & \text{if } \mathbf{x}^*\mathbf{y} \neq 0, \\ \mathrm{e}^{\mathrm{i}\theta},\ \theta \in [0, 2\pi), & \text{if } \mathbf{x}^*\mathbf{y} = 0, \end{cases}$$

and $\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{x} - z\mathbf{y}$. Verify $\mathbf{Hx} = z\mathbf{y}$. □

2. QR factorization via Householder reflectors ($m > n$)

- Householder method: $\mathbf{Q}_n \cdots \mathbf{Q}_2 \mathbf{Q}_1 \mathbf{A} = \mathbf{R}$ is upper-triangular.



$\times$ denotes an entry not necessarily zero; "*blank*" are zeros

- At the kth step, the unitary matrix $\mathbf{Q}_k$ has the form

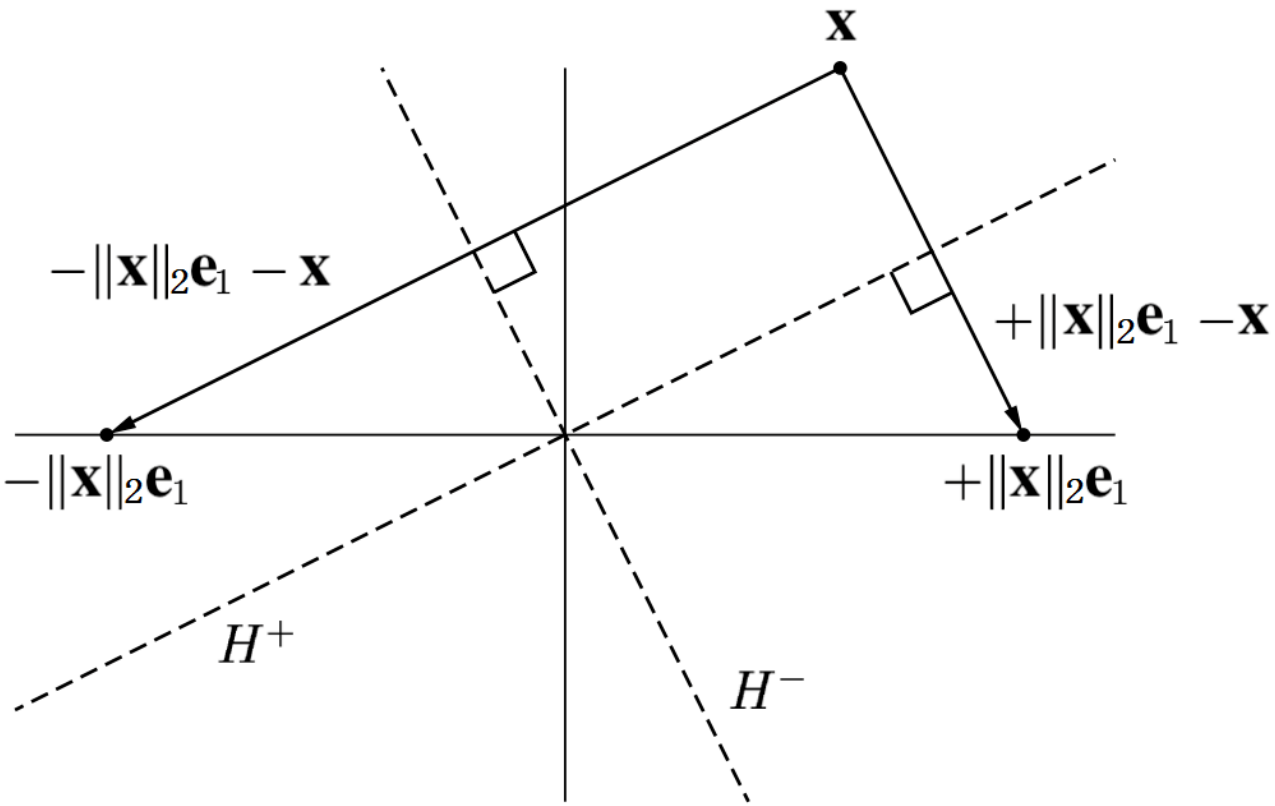
$$\mathbf{Q}_k = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{I}_{k-1} & \\ & \mathbf{H}_k \end{bmatrix}.$$

Here $\mathbf{H}_k$ is an $(m-k+1) \times (m-k+1)$ Householder reflector, which maps an $m-k+1$-vector to a scalar multiple of $\mathbf{e}_1$.

- The full QR factorization: $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{Q}_1^* \mathbf{Q}_2^* \cdots \mathbf{Q}_n^* \mathbf{R} = \mathbf{Q}\mathbf{R}$

- QR factorization with column pivoting: $\mathbf{AP} = \mathbf{QR}$. Consider "`qr`"

2.1. Two possible Householder reflections in real case



- Choose the one that moves $\mathbf{x}$ the larger distance, i.e.,
  $\mathbf{v} = -\text{sign}(x_1)\|\mathbf{x}\|_2\mathbf{e}_1 - \mathbf{x}$, or $\mathbf{v} = \text{sign}(x_1)\|\mathbf{x}\|_2\mathbf{e}_1 + \mathbf{x}$
- Convention: $\text{sign}(x_1) = 1$ if $x_1 = 0$. "$\neq$" `sign` of MATLAB

2.2. Algorithms

Algorithm: Householder QR factorization

for $k = 1$ **to** n

$\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{A}_{k:m,k}$

$\mathbf{v}_k = \text{sign}(x_1)\|\mathbf{x}\|_2 \mathbf{e}_1 + \mathbf{x}$

$\mathbf{v}_k = \mathbf{v}_k / \|\mathbf{v}_k\|_2$

$\mathbf{A}_{k:m,k:n} = \mathbf{A}_{k:m,k:n} - 2\mathbf{v}_k(\mathbf{v}_k^* \mathbf{A}_{k:m,k:n})$

end

Algorithm: Implicit calculations of $\mathbf{Q}^*\mathbf{b}$ or $\mathbf{Q}\mathbf{x}$

for $k = 1$ **to** n

$\mathbf{b}_{k:m} = \mathbf{b}_{k:m} - 2\mathbf{v}_k(\mathbf{v}_k^* \mathbf{b}_{k:m})$

end

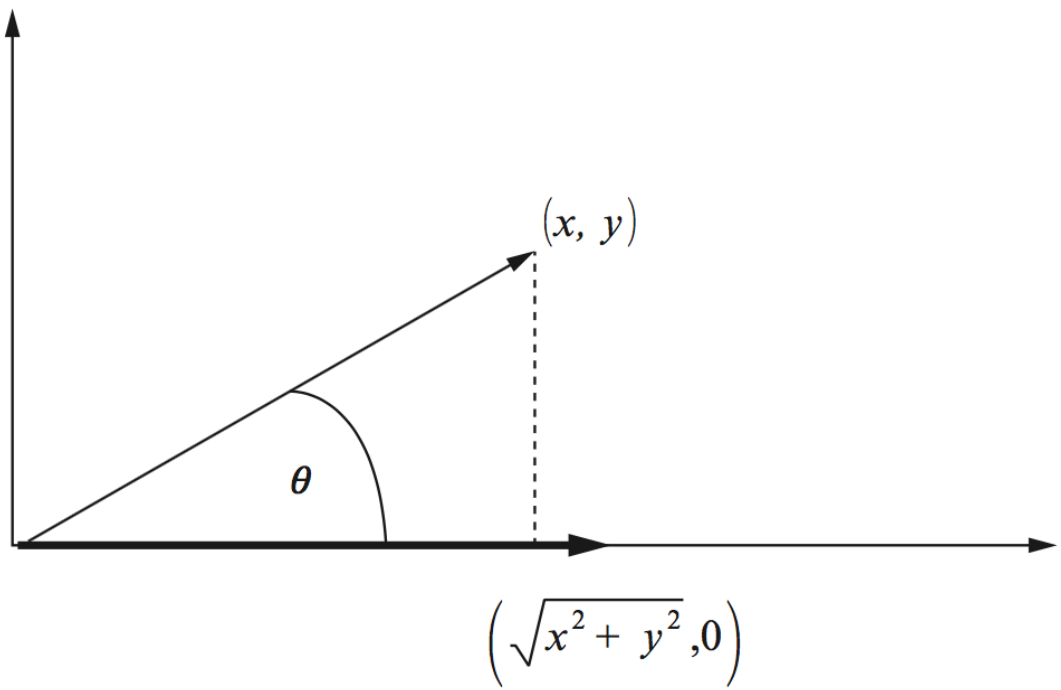
for $k = n$ **downto** 1

$\mathbf{x}_{k:m} = \mathbf{x}_{k:m} - 2\mathbf{v}_k(\mathbf{v}_k^* \mathbf{x}_{k:m})$

end

3. Givens rotation (We mainly consider the real case.)

- The 2×2 Givens rotation $\mathbf{G} = \begin{bmatrix} \cos\theta & \sin\theta \\ -\sin\theta & \cos\theta \end{bmatrix}$ rotates clockwise the vector $\begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \end{bmatrix}$ by the angle θ. For example, if $\cos\theta = \dfrac{x}{\sqrt{x^2+y^2}}$ and $\sin\theta = \dfrac{y}{\sqrt{x^2+y^2}}$, then $\mathbf{G}\begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \sqrt{x^2+y^2} \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}$.



- Givens rotation: $\begin{bmatrix} c & s \\ -s & c \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \times \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}$

Algorithm: Givens rotation zeroing the 2nd entry

---

function $[c, s] = \text{givens}(x, y)$

  if $y = 0$

    $c = 1, \quad s = 0$

  else

    if $|y| > |x|$

      $\tau = x/y, \quad s = 1/\sqrt{1+\tau^2}, \quad c = s\tau$

    else

      $\tau = y/x, \quad c = 1/\sqrt{1+\tau^2}, \quad s = c\tau$

  end

- Givens rotation: $\begin{bmatrix} c & s \\ -s & c \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ \times \end{bmatrix}$

Exercise: Design a similar algorithm as above.

- Zeroing a particular entry in a vector using a Givens rotation.

  Define the $m \times m$ Givens rotation $\mathbf{G}(i, j; \theta)$, $i < j$,

$$\mathbf{G}(i,j;\theta) = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{I} & & & & \\ & \cos\theta & & \sin\theta & \\ & & \mathbf{I} & & \\ & -\sin\theta & & \cos\theta & \\ & & & & \mathbf{I} \end{bmatrix} \begin{matrix} \\ \text{row } i \\ \\ \text{row } j \\ \\ \end{matrix}$$

$$= \mathbf{I} + \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{e}_i & \mathbf{e}_j \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} \cos\theta - 1 & \sin\theta \\ -\sin\theta & \cos\theta - 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{e}_i^\top \\ \mathbf{e}_j^\top \end{bmatrix}.$$

  Exercise: Prove that the matrix $\mathbf{G}(i, j; \theta)$ is orthogonal.

- Creating a sequence of zeros in a vector using Givens rotations

$$\mathbf{G}_n \mathbf{G}_{n-1} \cdots \mathbf{G}_1 \mathbf{x}$$

- QR factorization via Givens rotations?

  Exercise: Let $\mathbf{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{n\times n}$ be given as

$$\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} \alpha_1 & \beta_2 & \beta_3 & \cdots & \beta_n \\ \gamma_2 & \alpha_2 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ \gamma_3 & 0 & \alpha_3 & \ddots & \vdots \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \ddots & 0 \\ \gamma_n & 0 & \cdots & 0 & \alpha_n \end{bmatrix}, \qquad \begin{aligned} &\alpha_i \neq 0, \quad i = 1\colon n, \\ &\beta_i \neq 0, \quad i = 2\colon n, \\ &\gamma_i \neq 0, \quad i = 2\colon n. \end{aligned}$$

  Describe an algorithm for QR factorization of $\mathbf{A}$ based on as few Givens rotations as possible.

- Complex case:

$$\mathbf{G} = \begin{bmatrix} c & \bar{s} \\ -s & c \end{bmatrix}, \quad c \in \mathbb{R}, \quad s \in \mathbb{C}, \quad c^2 + |s|^2 = 1.$$

4. The least squares problem (LSP)

- LSP: Given $\mathbf{A} \in \mathbb{C}^{m\times n}, \mathbf{b} \in \mathbb{C}^m$; find $\mathbf{x}_{\text{ls}} \in \mathbb{C}^n$ such that

$$\|\mathbf{b} - \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x}_{\text{ls}}\|_2 = \min_{\mathbf{x}\in\mathbb{C}^n} \|\mathbf{b} - \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x}\|_2.$$

  LSP means that we seek a vector $\mathbf{x}_{\text{ls}} \in \mathbb{C}^n$ such that the vector $\mathbf{A}\mathbf{x}_{\text{ls}}$ is the closest point in range$(\mathbf{A})$ to $\mathbf{b}$.

  The *least squares solution*, $\mathbf{x}_{\text{ls}}$, maybe *not* unique. Why?

  The *residual*, $\mathbf{r}_{\text{ls}} = \mathbf{b} - \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x}_{\text{ls}}$, is unique. Why?

- Assume that $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{b}$ are real. Define

$$f(\mathbf{x}) := \|\mathbf{b} - \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x}\|_2^2 = \mathbf{b}^\top\mathbf{b} - \mathbf{x}^\top\mathbf{A}^\top\mathbf{b} - \mathbf{b}^\top\mathbf{A}\mathbf{x} + \mathbf{x}^\top\mathbf{A}^\top\mathbf{A}\mathbf{x}.$$

  Then the gradient of $f(\mathbf{x})$ is

$$\nabla f(\mathbf{x}) = 2\mathbf{A}^\top\mathbf{A}\mathbf{x} - 2\mathbf{A}^\top\mathbf{b}.$$

4.1. Theory of the least squares problem

Theorem 3

Let $\mathbf{P}$ *be the orthogonal projector onto* $\text{range}(\mathbf{A})$. *A vector* $\mathbf{x}$ *is a least squares solution if and only if* $\mathbf{x}$ *satisfies* $\mathbf{Ax} = \mathbf{Pb}$.

Hint:

$\|\mathbf{b} - \mathbf{Ax}\|_2^2 = \|\mathbf{Pb} - \mathbf{Ax} + \mathbf{b} - \mathbf{Pb}\|_2^2 = \|\mathbf{Pb} - \mathbf{Ax}\|_2^2 + \|\mathbf{b} - \mathbf{Pb}\|_2^2$. □

Corollary 4

A vector $\mathbf{x}$ *is a least squares solution if and only if* $\mathbf{x}$ *satisfies* $\mathbf{A}^*\mathbf{Ax} = \mathbf{A}^*\mathbf{b}$, *i.e.,* $\mathbf{A}^*\mathbf{r} = \mathbf{0}$, *or* $\mathbf{r} \perp \text{range}(\mathbf{A})$, *where* $\mathbf{r} := \mathbf{b} - \mathbf{Ax}$.

Sketh of the proof.

$\because \mathbf{A}^* = \mathbf{A}^*\mathbf{P}, \therefore \mathbf{A}^*\mathbf{r} = \mathbf{0} \Leftrightarrow \mathbf{A}^*(\mathbf{Pb} - \mathbf{Ax}) = \mathbf{0} \Leftrightarrow \mathbf{Ax} = \mathbf{Pb}$. □

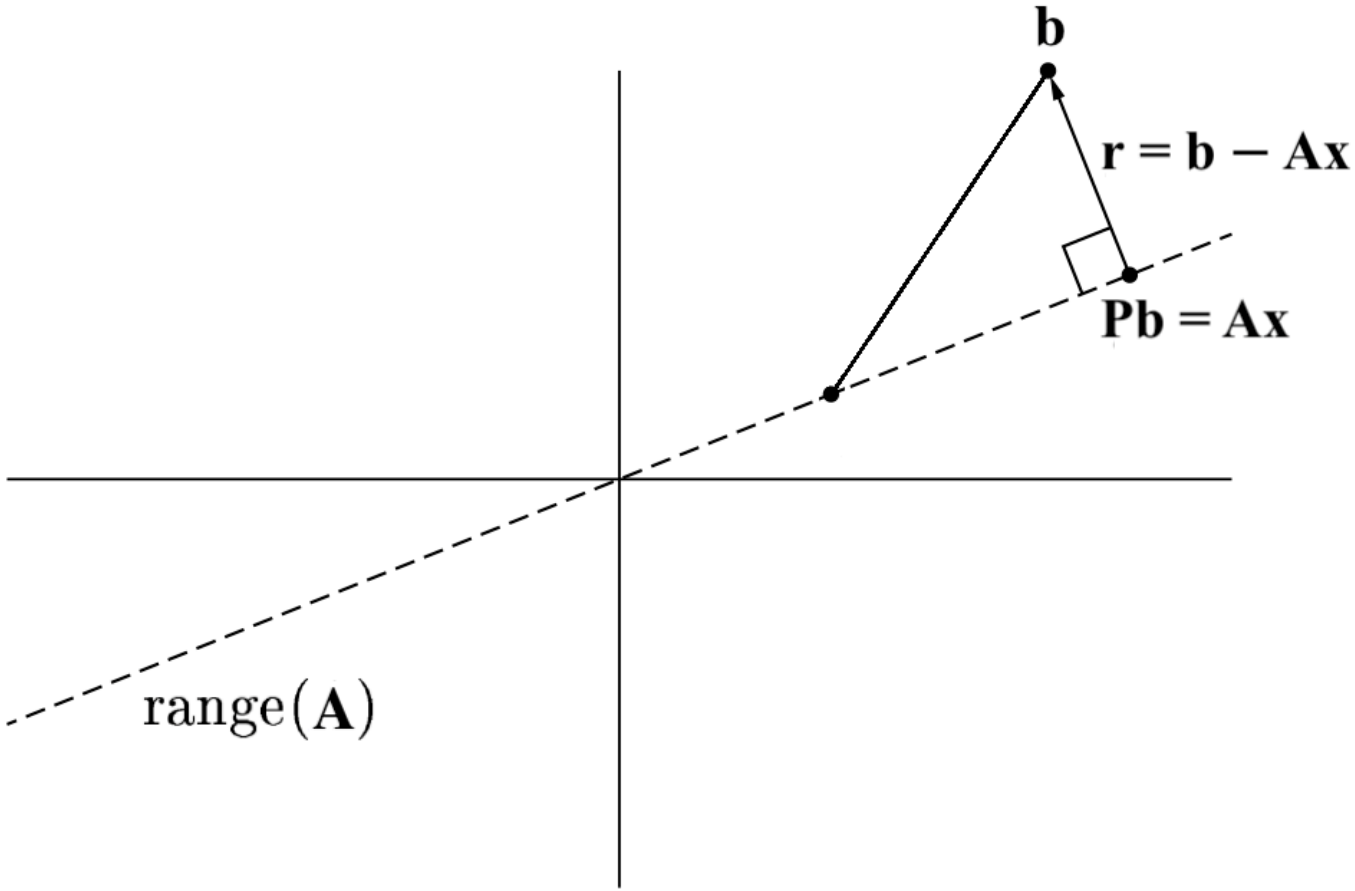
- The linear system $\mathbf{A}^*\mathbf{Ax} = \mathbf{A}^*\mathbf{b}$ is called the *normal equations*.

Corollary 5

The least squares solution $\mathbf{x}$ *is unique if and only if* $\mathbf{A}^*\mathbf{A}$ *has full rank, or equivalently,* $\mathbf{A}$ *has full column rank, i.e.,* $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) = n$.

4.2. Geometric interpretation

- Let $\mathbf{x}$ be a least squares solution. Obviously, $\mathbf{r} = \mathbf{b} - \mathbf{Pb}$ is unique.



4.3. Moore–Penrose pseudoinverse solution $\mathbf{A}^\dagger\mathbf{b}$

- Let $\mathbf{A} \in \mathbb{C}^{m\times n}$ have an SVD $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{U}_r\mathbf{\Sigma}_r\mathbf{V}_r^*$. The matrix

$$\mathbf{A}^\dagger = \mathbf{V}_r\mathbf{\Sigma}_r^{-1}\mathbf{U}_r^* = \sum_{j=1}^{r} \frac{1}{\sigma_j}\mathbf{v}_j\mathbf{u}_j^* \in \mathbb{C}^{n\times m},$$

  is called the *Moore–Penrose pseudoinverse* of $\mathbf{A}$. If $\mathbf{A}$ has full column rank, then $\mathbf{A}^\dagger = (\mathbf{A}^*\mathbf{A})^{-1}\mathbf{A}^*$. (Full row rank case?)

Theorem 6

Let $\mathbf{A} \in \mathbb{C}^{m\times n}$ have rank $r < n$ and $\mathbf{b} \in \mathbb{C}^m$. Then the vector $\mathbf{A}^\dagger\mathbf{b}$ is the unique least squares solution with minimum 2-norm.

Proof.

By SVD of $\mathbf{A}$, the least squares solutions can be expressed as

$$\mathbf{x}_{\text{ls}} = \mathbf{A}^\dagger\mathbf{b} + \mathbf{V}_c\mathbf{z}, \quad \mathbf{z} \in \mathbb{C}^{n-r}.$$

Then the statement follows from $\mathbf{A}^\dagger\mathbf{b} \perp \mathbf{V}_c\mathbf{z}$. □

4.4. Full column rank LSP solvers: $\operatorname{rank}(\mathbf{A}) = n$

- Normal equations: classical way to solve LSP, best for speed
- QR factorization: "modern classical" method to solve LSP, numerically stable. By

$$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{QR} = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{Q}_n & \mathbf{Q}_c \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{R}_n \\ \mathbf{0} \end{bmatrix},$$

  we have

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{\mathbf{x}\in\mathbb{C}^n} \|\mathbf{b} - \mathbf{Ax}\|_2 = \min_{\mathbf{x}\in\mathbb{C}^n} \|\mathbf{b} - \mathbf{QRx}\|_2 = \min_{\mathbf{x}\in\mathbb{C}^n} \|\mathbf{Q}^*\mathbf{b} - \mathbf{Rx}\|_2 \\ = \min_{\mathbf{x}\in\mathbb{C}^n} \left\| \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{Q}_n^*\mathbf{b} - \mathbf{R}_n\mathbf{x} \\ \mathbf{Q}_c^*\mathbf{b} \end{bmatrix} \right\|_2 \end{aligned}$$

- SVD, numerically stable, for problems close to rank-deficient. By

$$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{U\Sigma V}^* = \mathbf{U}_n\mathbf{\Sigma}_n\mathbf{V}^* = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{U}_n & \mathbf{U}_c \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{\Sigma}_n \\ \mathbf{0} \end{bmatrix} \mathbf{V}^*,$$

we have

$$\begin{aligned}\min_{\mathbf{x}\in\mathbb{C}^n} \|\mathbf{b}-\mathbf{A}\mathbf{x}\|_2 &= \min_{\mathbf{x}\in\mathbb{C}^n} \|\mathbf{b}-\mathbf{U}\boldsymbol{\Sigma}\mathbf{V}^*\mathbf{x}\|_2 \\ &= \min_{\mathbf{x}\in\mathbb{C}^n} \|\mathbf{U}^*\mathbf{b}-\boldsymbol{\Sigma}\mathbf{V}^*\mathbf{x}\|_2 \\ &= \min_{\mathbf{x}\in\mathbb{C}^n} \left\| \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{U}_n^*\mathbf{b}-\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_n\mathbf{V}^*\mathbf{x} \\ \mathbf{U}_c^*\mathbf{b} \end{bmatrix} \right\|_2 .\end{aligned}$$

Exercise: Given $\mathbf{A}\in\mathbb{C}^{m\times n}$ of full column rank, $m>n$, $\mathbf{b}\in\mathbb{C}^m$, $\mathbf{b}\notin \text{range}(\mathbf{A})$ and $\mathbf{QR}=\begin{bmatrix}\mathbf{A} & \mathbf{b}\end{bmatrix}$ (i.e., full QR factorization of $\begin{bmatrix}\mathbf{A} & \mathbf{b}\end{bmatrix}$). Show that

$$\min_{\mathbf{x}\in\mathbb{C}^n} \|\mathbf{b}-\mathbf{A}\mathbf{x}\|_2 = |\mathbf{R}(n+1,n+1)|,$$

and the least squares solution is given by

$$\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{R}(1\colon n, 1\colon n)\backslash\mathbf{R}(1\colon n, n+1).$$

4.5. Rank-deficient LSP solvers: $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) = r < n$

- QR factorization with column pivoting for $\mathbf{A} \in \mathbb{C}^{m\times n}$:

$$\mathbf{AP} = \mathbf{QR} = \mathbf{Q}\begin{bmatrix}\mathbf{R}_{11} & \mathbf{R}_{12}\\ \mathbf{0} & \mathbf{0}\end{bmatrix},$$

where $\mathbf{P} \in \mathbb{R}^{n\times n}$ is a permutation matrix ($\mathbf{PP}^\top = \mathbf{P}^\top\mathbf{P} = \mathbf{I}$), $\mathbf{Q} \in \mathbb{C}^{m\times m}$ is unitary ($\mathbf{Q}^*\mathbf{Q} = \mathbf{QQ}^* = \mathbf{I}$), and $\mathbf{R}_{11} \in \mathbb{C}^{r\times r}$ is nonsingular upper triangular. Introduce the auxiliary vectors

$$\mathbf{Q}^*\mathbf{b} = \begin{bmatrix}\mathbf{d}_1\\ \mathbf{d}_2\end{bmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad \mathbf{P}^\top\mathbf{x} = \begin{bmatrix}\mathbf{y}_1\\ \mathbf{y}_2\end{bmatrix}.$$

The general least squares solution is

$$\mathbf{x}_{\text{ls}} = \mathbf{P}\begin{bmatrix}\mathbf{R}_{11}^{-1}(\mathbf{d}_1 - \mathbf{R}_{12}\mathbf{y}_2)\\ \mathbf{y}_2\end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{y}_2 = \text{arbitrary}.$$

The case $\mathbf{y}_2 = \mathbf{0}$ yields a least squares solution with at least $n - r$ zero components. Consider "\" in MATLAB.

- Complete orthogonal factorization (also called UTV factorization)

$$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{U} \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{R}_{11} & \mathbf{0} \\ \mathbf{0} & \mathbf{0} \end{bmatrix} \mathbf{V}^*,$$

where $\mathbf{U} \in \mathbb{C}^{m \times m}$ is unitary, $\mathbf{V} \in \mathbb{C}^{n \times n}$ is unitary, and $\mathbf{R}_{11} \in \mathbb{C}^{r \times r}$ is nonsingular upper triangular. Introduce the auxiliary vectors

$$\mathbf{U}^* \mathbf{b} = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{g}_1 \\ \mathbf{g}_2 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad \mathbf{V}^* \mathbf{x} = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{y}_1 \\ \mathbf{y}_2 \end{bmatrix}.$$

The general least squares solution is

$$\mathbf{x}_{\text{ls}} = \mathbf{V} \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{y}_1 \\ \mathbf{y}_2 \end{bmatrix} = \mathbf{V} \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{R}_{11}^{-1} \mathbf{g}_1 \\ \mathbf{y}_2 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{y}_2 = \text{arbitrary}.$$

The case $\mathbf{y}_2 = \mathbf{0}$ yields the minimum 2-norm least squares solution. Consider `lsqminnorm` in MATLAB.

`http://www.netlib.org/numeralgo/`

5. Solutions of $\mathbf{Ax} = \mathbf{b}$ with $\mathbf{A} \in \mathbb{C}^{m\times n}$ and $\mathbf{b} \in \mathbb{C}^m$

